

26-142 - Supplemental Appropriation for the Fiscal Year 2027



July 30, 2026

Via Electronic Delivery
To the Honorable President and
Members of the Medford City Council
Medford City Hall
85 George P. Hassett Drive
Medford, MA 02155

Re: Supplemental Appropriation for the Fiscal Year 2027

Dear President Bears and Members of the City Council:

I respectfully request and recommend that your Honorable Body approves the following supplemental appropriation for Fiscal Year 2027, to restore the Law Department budget, which was originally proposed in a June 4, 2026 submission to the City Council.

	Mayor Proposed 6/4/26	City Council Cut on 6/23/26
Salaries	\$230,866.60	\$182,576.33
Ordinary	\$298,700.00	\$242,500.00
Total	\$529,566.60	\$425,076.33

And to meet this appropriation, the sum of Four Hundred Twenty-Five Thousand Seventy-Six Dollars and Thirty-Three Cents (\$425,076.33) be raised and appropriated from the Fiscal Year 2026 tax levy.

Over the past several weeks, we have made a thoughtful effort to engage with the Council on this appropriation as well as the provisions of legal documents responsive to your records requests. On May 13th, we responded to the Council's public records request, noting that Item (a) alone, of the nine requested items, would take an estimated 395 hours to review just email records.

On June 16th, we supplied the Council with 130 pages of City-side settlements and School-side settlements between 2020 and the Council's request.

On June 23rd, we provided the spending detail in the Fire Department Professional Services line as well as an outline of other legal expenditures incurred by the City in Fiscal Year 2026 budget. You may recall, I wrote to the full Council on June 3rd offering to discuss the most effective process for providing those materials. My Chief of Staff also requested at both the June 9th and June 23rd Council meetings that the Council designate a member to work with our office on this matter. We unfortunately have yet to receive a response.

Most recently, on July 23rd, we supplied an updated breakdown of Medford's FY26 budget legal spending compared to other communities and on the same date, I emailed the Council President asking how we can reach an understanding so that my office could begin working a grant agreement to help fund Medford Family Network, begin the recruitment process for a new arts liaison position, and other budget priorities. I have not heard back on this request as of yet.

My administration has consistently sought to engage with the Council in a collaborative and transparent manner, and we remain committed to doing so. However, our repeated requests for coordination and communication with the Council have thus far gone unanswered. It is important that we receive direction and feedback from the Council collectively, or at least from a majority of its members, so that we can be confident we are proceeding in accordance with the Council's expectations and are not expending City staff time and resources pursuing work that may ultimately prove unnecessary or incomplete.

Thank you for your kind attention to this matter.

Sincerely,


Breanna Lungo-KoeHN
Mayor

Councilor Tseng motioned to Amend the Appropriation paper to cut 382,586.70 from the Appropriation and approve 42,507.63 one-month funding (seconded by Councilor Scarpelli) – Approved on a Roll call vote of Seven in favor, Zero opposed

26-142B - Council Response to Paper 26-142

Offered by President Bears
Motion to Approve: Councilor Tseng
Approved Unanimously

Whereas, the Medford City Council unanimously approved Resolution 26-043 on February 24, 2026 requesting a comprehensive litigation report from the City Administration regarding the significant increase in legal claims against the City of Medford since January